The Praise of the Compassion of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī

Āryamañjuśrībhaṭṭārakakaruṇāstotra · Toh 1132 · Derge Tengyur
རྗེབཙུན་འཕགས་པ་འཇམ་དཔལ་གཞོན་ནུར་རྟོག་པར་བརྗོད་པ

This is The Praise of the Compassion of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī, known in Sanskrit as the Āryamañjuśrībhaṭṭārakakaruṇāstotra and in Tibetan as Jetsün Pakpa Jampal gyi Nyingjé la Töpa. It is a short devotional hymn in verse, ascribed in its colophon to the master Nāgārjuna, written in the voice of a suffering devotee who praises the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī's boundless compassion while lamenting that it seems not to reach him. Stanza by stanza the poet sets Mañjuśrī's lotus eyes, outstretched hand, and attentive ears, which help all beings, against his own unrelieved misery, at times blaming his own ill fortune and sinful mind, and asks to whom else he could turn for refuge. The hymn closes by dedicating the virtue of this lament so that the poet may become like Mañjuśrī's youthful body, a wish-fulfilling source of merit for beings. It is Toh 1132 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the Praises (stotra) section.

In the language of India: ārya mañjuśrī bhaṭṭāraka kāruṇa stotra. In the language of Tibet: The Praise of the Compassion of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī.

Homage to Mañjuśrī in youthful form.

You who have utterly dispelled every fault,
Whose renown as a sage pervades every being,
Who possess a glorious and supremely steadfast body:
Glorious one, to you I always bow.

Calling again and again to all beings,
You protect them from all these miseries;
Though I, lowly, am suffering and cry, "O you!",
Why is it that you do not surely take it away?

Blessed One, if you are renowned for always
Bestowing everything, in every way, upon all,
Then, since you have not granted me even a glimpse,
I am, therefore, utterly lacking in fortune.

If you of excellent mind, endowed with good qualities and dispelling faults,
Strive to protect all beings,
Then though my mind is openly devoted to you,

Why should I be tormented by misery?

You whose very nature is compassion,
With your two pure eyes like lotuses
You bring benefit to beings, yet that you do not look
Upon me in my misery: alas, how painful!

Though you constantly stretch out, reaching far,
Your lotus hand that brings relief to frightened minds,
Through the fever of my ill fortune, even that
Becomes far off and passes from my sight.

Your ears are unimpaired and pure;
Yet though, my body racked with suffering,
I cry out for help before your eyes,
Why have both of them not heard my wretched plight?

If you, drawn on by compassion in every way,
Bring happiness to the beings who have gone to the hells,
Then toward me, a sinner, Blessed One,
That compassion of yours holds no tenderness.

If you, who bring benefit to the lowly world,
Indulge in this youthful play,
Then that you do not protect me here, though I am racked by suffering,
Is the fault of this sinner's own thoughts.

Asking, "Who here is suffering?
What fool has lost his fortune, and by what?",
You roam about like this, giving protection,
Yet you do not see my destitution: alas, how strange!

"To whom shall I give counsel? To whom
Shall I at once give vast abundance?":
With your supreme wisdom striving like this,
Why is it that you do not protect me?

Who that has faith in you is not happy?
None who is with you is poor in merit.
"Though I have faith in you, why
Have I come to suffer?": at this, wonder fills me.

If even you, the great physician
Who cuts off suffering, cast me aside,
Then to whom else would you tell me, bereft of merit,
To go for refuge?

You who always hold beings in a heart of love
As though each were your only child, and who act to set them free:
If even you do not dispel my harm,
Then I am without a protector, and lost.

Blessed One, if by mere mindfulness of you
You grant beings every incomparable fruit,
Then though I serve and honor you,
Why do you in every way put off my cause?

Whatever virtue I have gathered
By thus lamenting and supplicating, telling a mere fraction of your qualities,
Through it may I become your youthful body,
For beings an excellent vase of merit, vast and accomplished by its own nature,
A form body like a wish-fulfilling jewel,
Like a wish-granting tree that walks on two feet;
And in all my births
May I be a master.

The Praise of the Compassion of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī, composed by the master, the noble Nāgārjuna, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• In the third stanza the Tibetan reads gsol, which does not fit the line; the similar-looking stsol ("bestow") is read, matching ma stsal ("have not granted") in the next line. In the ninth stanza the last line is read as the speaker blaming his own sinful mind; it could also mean that it is wrong to withhold protection on the thought that he is a sinner.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please

consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.